

331 Investigate a fallen log

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MINS

Nothing is wasted in nature. Look closely at a fallen log, and you'll see that it is home to hundreds of tiny creatures—and other plants and fungi. Observe this essential habitat, but do your best not to disturb it.

What you need

- Sketchbook
- Pen or pencil
- Digital camera
- Magnifying glass



1 Look at the outside of the log. Does it seem like it has been here long or is it newly fallen? Is the bark whole or crumbly?



2 Look closer at the log's surface. Do you see holes or spider webs? Lift a piece of bark—are there patterns in the wood?



Has an animal made holes in the log?

3 See if there are any signs of animal activity or tracks around the log. Note down any plants or animals you find, or take photos to identify later.

Fallen logs are often known as "nurse logs" because they provide a sheltered spot for other seedlings to grow. The rotting material also adds nutrients to the soil.

332 Log your log

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Make a log or journal of all the living things you find on or near a fallen log. Revisit your log from time to time to see whether anything has changed. Is something new living there?



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